WEEKLY BULLETIN

SHABBAT HA'AZINU AND KIPPUR 5787

18–21 September 2026 · 7–10 Tishri 5787

> WHAT MAKES US DIFFERENT?
>
> TRADITIONAL, BUT EGALITARIAN.
>
> *Everyone welcome, all included.*

SERVICE TIMES FOR KEHILLAH KEDOSHAH ZIKHRON ZVI

All times approximate

SHABBAT SHUVAH — SATURDAY MORNING

Please feel free to come and go as you wish.

BERAKHOT *Morning Blessings*	10:00 am
ZEMIROT *Pesukei DeZimrah — Psalms*	10:15 am
SHAHRIT *Morning Service*	10:30 am
SEFER *Reading of the Torah and Haftarah*	11:00 am
MUSAF *Additional Service*	12:00 noon
CONCLUSION OF SERVICES & KIDDUSH *You can come just for this if prayer and Torah reading is not your thing*	12:30 pm

KIPPUR — SUNDAY NIGHT AND MONDAY

No services will be held at the Kehillah for Kippur this year. We will be at Shearith Israel in New York.

HALAKHIC (RITUAL) TIMES — POUGHKEEPSIE, NY 41.70 N 73.92 W

CANDLE LIGHTING *Erev Shabbat, Friday, 18 September · 18 minutes to sunset*	6:42 pm
SUNSET *Erev Shabbat, Friday, 18 September*	7:00 pm
HABDALA *Saturday, 19 September · end of Shabbat*	7:33 pm
CANDLE LIGHTING *Erev Kippur, Sunday, 20 September · 18 minutes to sunset*	6:38 pm
SUNSET *Sunday, 20 September*	6:56 pm
FAST BEGINS *Erev Kippur, Sunday, 20 September · with candle lighting*	6:38 pm
FAST ENDS *Monday, 21 September · Habdala, Kippur ends*	7:29 pm

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TORAH READING & HAFTARAH

Ha'azinu, Deuteronomy 32:1–52.

Moses speaks his song with heaven and earth listening. He calls the Holy One the Rock, faithful and without wrong, and asks Israel to remember the days of old and to ask the elders what they know. The eagle appears, rousing its young and bearing them up on its wings. Then Jeshurun grows fat and forgets the Rock who gave him birth, and hard words follow: a hidden face, fire, famine, arrows. The song turns again toward mercy and the God who gives life. At the end Moses is told to climb Mount Nebo and see the land.

Haftarah: Hosea 14:2–10; Micah 7:18–20, the Sephardic reading (Ashkenazim read Hosea 14:2–10; Joel 2:15–27).

Hosea opens with the word that gives this Shabbat its name: shuba, return. Israel is told to come back with words, to say them out loud, and to give up the horses and the work of its own hands, which saved no one. The answer is immediate. The Eternal promises to heal their turning away and to love them freely, to be like dew to Israel, so that the people blossom like a lily and take root like Lebanon. The Sephardic reading closes with Micah: who is a God like You, pardoning iniquity and casting our sins into the depths of the sea.

Kippur, Leviticus 16:1–34; maftir Numbers 29:7–11.

Leviticus 16 begins after the death of Aaron's two sons. Aaron may not come into the Shrine whenever he wishes. He enters once a year, bathed and dressed in plain linen, with a bull for himself and his household and two goats from the people. Lots are cast over the goats, one for the Eternal and one for Azazel. Incense makes a cloud before the cover of the Ark, blood is sprinkled, and the Shrine, the Tent, and the altar are cleared of Israel's impurity. Over the live goat Aaron confesses everything, and it is sent to the wilderness. The maftir in Numbers gives the offerings of the day.

Haftarah: Isaiah 57:14–58:14. Ashkenazim and Sephardim read the same passage.

Isaiah is told to clear the road and lift the obstacles from the path of the people. The Holy One, who dwells on high, promises to be with the crushed and the lowly in spirit, to heal them, to lead them, and to give peace to the far and the near. Then comes the quarrel about fasting. The people ask why their fast goes unnoticed, and the answer is that on their fast day they press their workers and fall into strife. The fast the Eternal wants unlocks wickedness, frees the oppressed, shares bread with the hungry, takes the poor home, clothes the naked. Then light breaks like the dawn.

Kippur, Minhah reading, Leviticus 18:1–30.

The Minhah reading opens with the Eternal's own voice: I am your God. Israel is told to keep these laws and to live by them, and to leave behind the practices of Egypt and of Canaan. What follows concerns the family: the boundaries within a household, parents and children, brothers and sisters, aunts and in-laws, and a neighbor's wife. Children are not to be given to Molech, and the Name is not to be profaned. The chapter ends with the land itself, which will not tolerate defilement, and with one standard for the citizen and for the stranger who lives among you.

Haftarah: Jonah 1:1–4:11; Micah 7:18–20. Ashkenazim and Sephardim read the same passage.

Jonah is sent to Nineveh and goes the other way. A storm comes, the sailors pray each to his own god and then to the Eternal, and Jonah asks to be thrown into the sea. A great fish swallows him; he prays, and he is put ashore. The second time he goes. The city believes at once, from the king down to the animals, and God relents. Jonah is angry, and the book ends with a plant, a worm, a hot wind, and a question about a great city of a hundred and twenty thousand people who do not know their right hand from their left. Micah follows: our sins cast into the sea.

IN THE WEEK AHEAD

Saturday, 19 September — Shabbat Shuba.

Sunday, 20 September — Erev Kippur. Candle lighting 6:38 pm (18 minutes to sunset); sunset 6:56 pm.

Monday, 21 September — Kippur.

Friday, 25 September — Erev Sukkot. Candle lighting 6:30 pm (18 minutes to sunset); sunset 6:48 pm.

Saturday, 26 September — Sukkot, first day.

KIDDUSH

Kiddush follows the service. Meals are dairy and vegetarian.

We meet in a private home; our address is shared by message. If prayer is not your thing, you are welcome to join only for the Kiddush and the company.

To RSVP and to register food issues and avoidances, kindly contact the Congregation's secretary at kehillatzikhronzvi@gmail.com by Thursday night at 10:00 pm

KKZZ is free to join, there is no membership fee, and we never solicit contributions from members, students, parents or alumni. You may, if you wish, sponsor a meal or contribute to the work of the Congregation. Kehillah Kedoshah Zikhron Zvi is a tax-exempt charitable organization under Section 501(c)(3) of the Internal Revenue Code; offerings are tax-deductible to the extent permitted by law.

REFLECTIONS ON THE PARASHA AND KIPPUR

HALAKHA

The Rambam teaches that the affliction of the tenth of Tishri runs through the night and the day alike, and that the day is given more room than its own hours. We add to it from the common time at both ends, beginning in the afternoon of the ninth and letting a little of the night of the eleventh pass before we stop, since Scripture speaks of evening to evening.[1] Confession begins earlier still. The Rambam rules that the vidui is first said on the eve of Kippur, before the last meal, and then again at each service of the day, from Arbit through Ne'ila.[2] So the fast is entered before it starts and left after it ends.

The words of Kal Nidre have never been settled. The text of Rav Sa'adia Gaon looks back over the year that has gone; Rabbenu Tam turned it toward the year ahead. Rav Hai Gaon and Rav Nissim Gaon objected to annulling vows on these days at all and said that the two academies did not do it.[3] At the vidui, Sephardim in the East strike the place of the heart with a closed hand. In London and Amsterdam that custom is unknown.[4]

1. Mishneh Torah, Rest on the Tenth of Tishrei 1:6 2. Mishneh Torah, Repentance 2:7 3. Keter Shem Tob, vol. 6, pp. 309\u2013310 4. Keter Shem Tob, vol. 6, p. 28

AGGADA

"Like an eagle who rouses its nestlings." Rashi, following the Sifrei, notices what the eagle does before it comes home. It beats its wings above the young, moving between one tree and the next, so that they wake and have the strength to receive it.[1] The Sifrei says the Torah came to Israel in the same manner, disclosed from four directions at once.[2] Teshuvah has that shape. There is a waking first, and then the wings spread underneath, and the young are lifted.

1. Rashi on Deuteronomy 32:11 2. Sifrei Devarim 314:1

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Torah readings and calendar data by Hebcal.com (CC BY 4.0). Times are computed for Poughkeepsie by the congregation's luach; the end of Shabbat follows the convention of Congregation Shearith Israel, New York.

KEHILLAH KEDOSHAH ZIKHRON ZVI

A traditional egalitarian home minyan in the Hudson Valley, in the Western Sephardic liturgical tradition.

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